AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
All Branches
MIDTERM (MAKE UP)

2024-2025 / First Semester
Date: 24 April 2025
12:00 – 2:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are TWO sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer <u>two</u> questions from <u>Section 1</u>, and <u>One</u> question from <u>Section 2</u>.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with a conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyze and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1. **Does the traditional version of *Little Red Riding Hood* reinforce gender stereotypes, or can it be interpreted as a simple cautionary tale? (5 marks)**

2. **"Roald Dahl's version subverts expectations by making Red Riding Hood confident and resourceful shifting from a passive to an empowered subject who controls her own narrative". Comment. (5 marks)**

3. **To what extent does L. M. Alcott's *Little Women* function as a feminist text? Comment with reference to Mrs. March. (5 marks)**

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING/ CLOSE READING (20 MARKS)

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 in 250 WORDS.

Question 1: ESSAY WRITING

"In L. M. Alcott's *Little Women*, the contrasting settings—the March family home, Laurie's wealthier household, and the European backdrop of Amy's travels—shape each sister's character development."

OR

Question 2: CLOSE READING

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Do a close reading of the passage from Louisa May Alcott's *Little Women* focusing on Amy's moral growth.

Later in the evening, when his mind had been set at rest about the bootjack, Laurie said suddenly to his wife, 'Mrs. Laurence.' 'My Lord!' 'That man intends to marry our Jo!' 'I hope so, don't you, dear?'

'Well, my love, I consider him a trump, in the fullest sense of that expressive word, but I do wish he was a little younger and a good deal richer.'

'Now, Laurie, don't be too fastidious and worldly minded. If they love one another, it doesn't matter a particle how old they are nor how poor. Women never should marry for money...' Amy caught herself up short as the words escaped her, and looked at her husband, who replied, with malicious gravity...

'Certainly not, though you do hear charming girls say that they intend to do it sometimes. If my memory serves me, you once thought it your duty to make a rich match. That accounts, perhaps, for your marrying a good-for nothing like me.'

'Oh, my dearest boy, don't, don't say that! I forgot you were rich when I said 'Yes'. I'd have married you if you hadn't a penny, and I sometimes wish you were poor that I might show how much I love you.' And Amy, who was very dignified in public and very fond in private, gave convincing proofs of the truth of her words.

'You don't really think I am such a mercenary creature as I tried to be once, do you? It would break my heart if you didn't believe that I'd gladly pull in the same boat with you, even if you had to get your living by rowing on the lake.'

'Am I an idiot and a brute? How could I think so, when you refused a richer man for me, and won't let me give you half I want to now, when I have the right? Girls do it every day, poor things, and are taught to think it is their only salvation, but you had better lessons, and though I trembled for you at one time, I was not disappointed, for the daughter was true to the mother's teaching.

***Little Women* (1868) p. 801-2**

End of Exam

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